

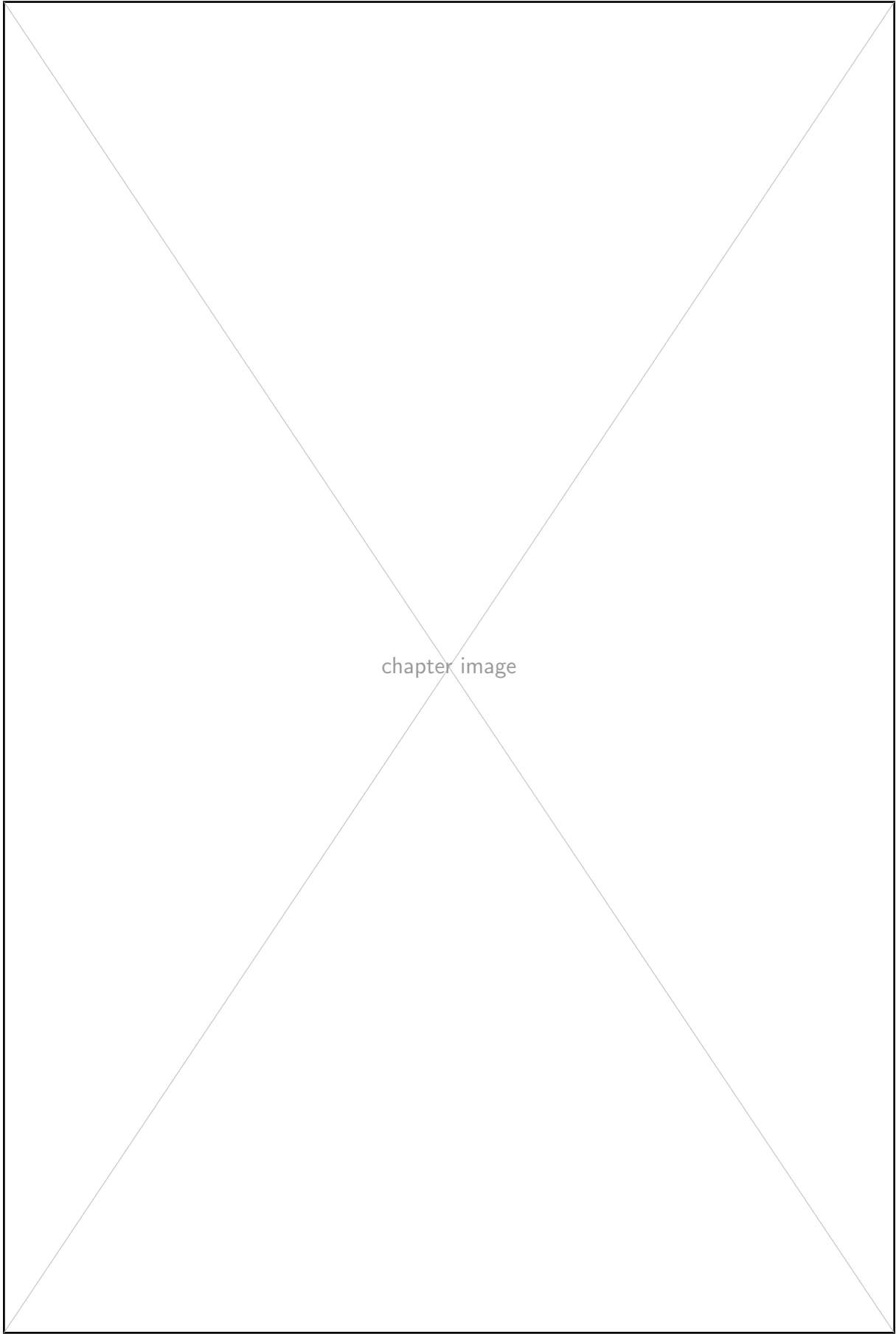


THE COOKBOOK

A collection of recipes

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SAUCES & MARINADES



CHIMICHURRI

This is a classic Argentinian sauce, but as it's popular with the ranchers of Rio Grande do Sul, I've considered it Brazilian. This should be intensely flavoured, and the volume can be turned up or down the various constituents according to taste. Personally, I like it moderately spicy, with only a little garlic. The key herb here is oregano, which gives it a distinctive flavour. Always use fresh oregano if you can find it. I am to make ~150ml at a time, and leave it to muddle for a while if you can.

Ingredients

- Bunch fresh oregano
- Good flat-leaf parsley (not too stalky, dark green)
- 1 juicy tomato, diced
- 1 clove garlic, finely chopped
- 1 fresh red chilli, finely diced
- 3 tbsp red wine vinegar
- 4 tbsp extra virgin olive oil
- A good amount of salt & black pepper

Instructions

1. Finely chop the parsley by hand — don't use a blender or food processor, it turns it into a paste.
2. Combine parsley, oregano, garlic, and chilli in a bowl.
3. Stir in the vinegar and olive oil. Season generously.

Hints & Tips

- Use as a condiment, rather than a marinade.
- Avoid too much oil. Balance with more tomato if it's a little dry
- I like using mild salad vinegar - not malt or balsamic vinegar. Greek supermarkets often stock a good salad vinegar.

Spicy Vinaigrette *A Brazilian-style molho vinagrete — more salsa than dressing. Goes with everything grilled.*

Ingredients

- 3 tbsp red wine vinegar
- 4 tbsp olive oil
- 1 clove garlic, very finely minced
- 1 fresh red chilli, finely diced
- 1/2 green pepper, very finely diced
- 1 ripe tomato, deseeded and finely diced
- 1/2 small onion, very finely diced
- Salt & pepper to taste

Instructions

1. Combine the vinegar, olive oil, and garlic in a bowl and whisk to emulsify.
2. Add the chilli, green pepper, tomato, and onion. Stir well.
3. Season generously. Leave to stand for at least 15 minutes before serving so the vegetables soften slightly.

Hints & Tips

- All the vegetables should be cut very finely — this is a sauce, not a salsa.
- Makes ahead well; keeps in the fridge for 2 days.

Pol Sambol *A Sri Lankan fresh coconut relish — spicy, tangy, and addictive.*

Ingredients

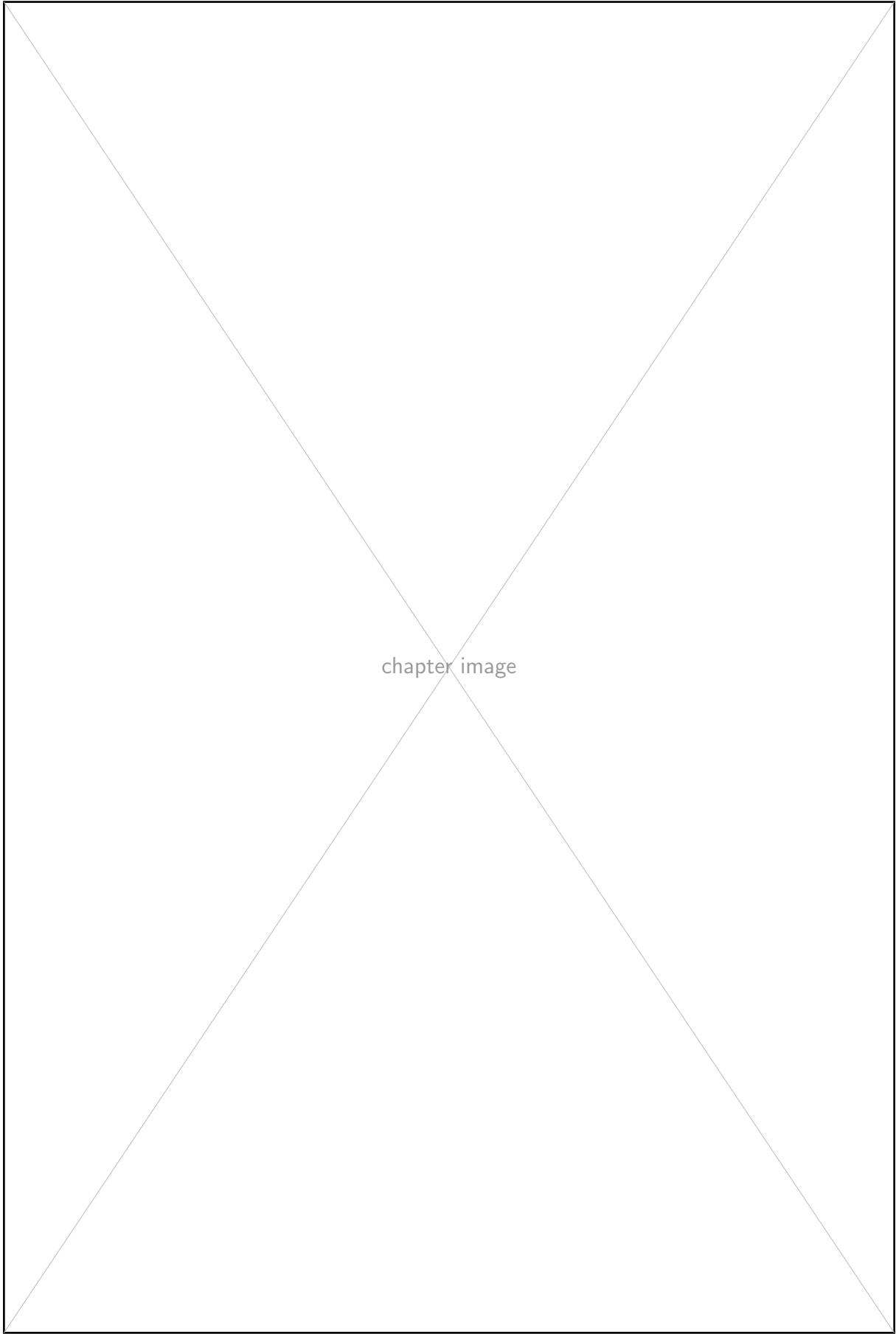
- 100g freshly grated coconut (or desiccated, rehydrated)
- 2 shallots, finely sliced
- 2 fresh red chillies, roughly chopped
- Juice of 1 lime
- 1/2 tsp salt

Instructions

1. Put all the ingredients into a pestle and mortar and pound until well combined — the coconut should be slightly broken down but still have texture.
2. Taste and adjust: more lime for acidity, more chilli for heat, more salt if needed.
3. Serve as a condiment alongside rice and curry.

Hints & Tips

- Fresh chilli is best, but dried/powdered chilli is fine — use 1/2 tsp.
- Loosen with a little coconut water if it seems dry.
- Desiccated coconut works but soak it in warm water for 10 minutes first and drain well.



Pão de Queijo, fresh from the oven



STARTERS & SNACKS



PÃO DE QUEIJO

These iconic Brazilian cheese puffs are crisp on the outside and delightfully chewy (almost mochi-like) on the inside. They are naturally gluten-free and dangerously addictive!

Ingredients

- 500g Tapioca Starch (250g Doce / 250g Azedo)
- 250g Whole Milk (oat is fine)
- 100ml Water
- 100ml Vegetable Oil
- 10g Salt
- 3 Eggs
- 150g Parmesan, finely grated
- 100g Mozzarella or mild cheddar, grated

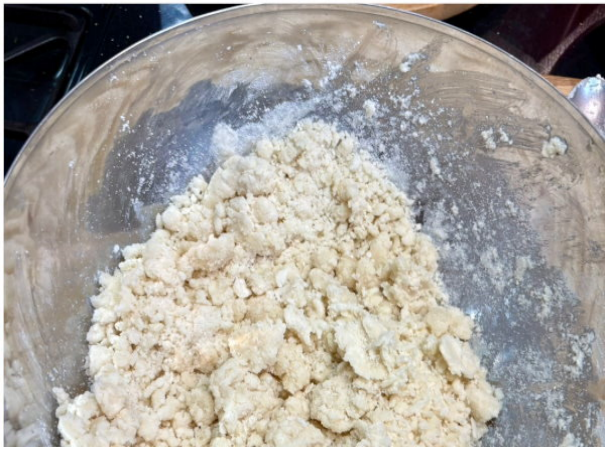
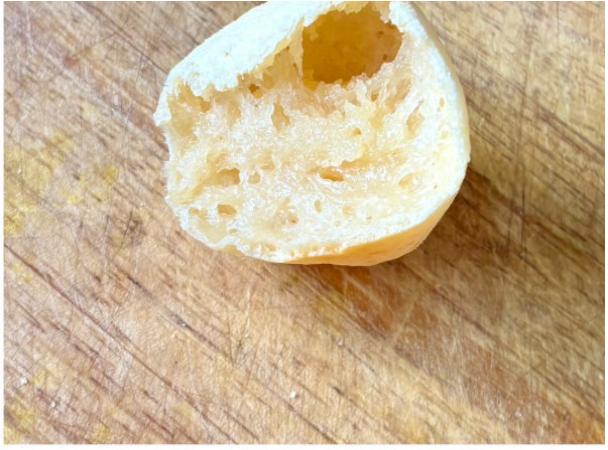
Instructions

1. Bring milk, water, oil, and salt to a rolling boil and pour over the tapioca.
2. Allow the dough to cool for 15 minutes.
3. Incorporate eggs one at a time and add the cheeses.
4. Preheat oven to 190°C. Roll 30g balls.
5. Bake for 20-25 minutes.

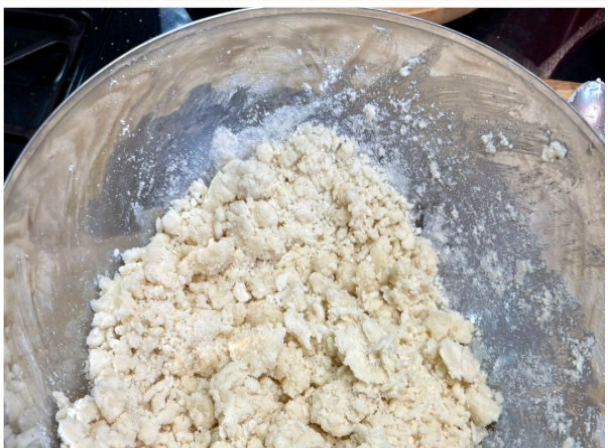
Hints & Tips

- Scalding causes starch gelatinization, creating the elastic matrix that traps steam for the rise.
- Starch Ratio: 100% Doce yields a dense roll; 100% Azedo creates a hollow puff.





The dough, just after scalding



Ready to roll

CALDO VERDE

Ingredients

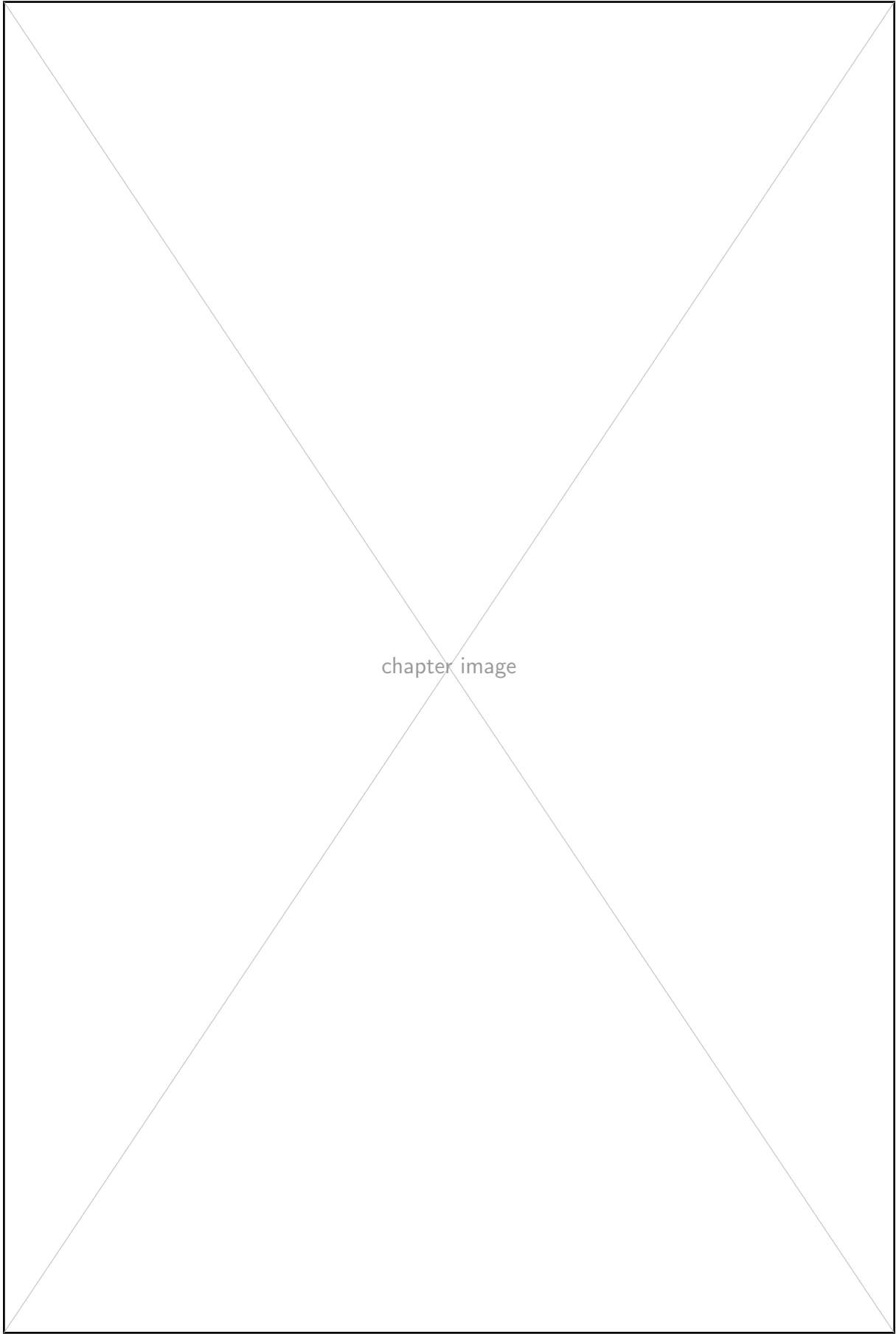
- Chicken stock
- Finely-chopped couve (collard greens)
- Potatoes
- Calabresa sausage (similar to kielbasa)
- Onion
- Garlic

Instructions

1. Cook the potatoes in the chicken stock and some water until tender. Do not drain them.
2. Fry-off the sausage, onion and garlic until translucent.
3. Add the couve (collard greens) and cook until wilted.
4. Take one or two potatoes out, and blend the rest using a hand blender
5. Add the onion, garlic, sausage and couve mixture back into the soup and simmer for 10 minutes.

Hints & Tips

- Spanish chorizo will make the soup red, and taste of paprika, which is not traditional.
- The key is to get the number of potatoes right so the soup is thickened but not too heavy.
- Serve with chilli sauce.





SALADS



SALADE NIÇOISE

The definitive composed salad. Tuna, eggs, olives, and green beans on a bed of dressed leaves — substantial enough to be a main course.

Ingredients

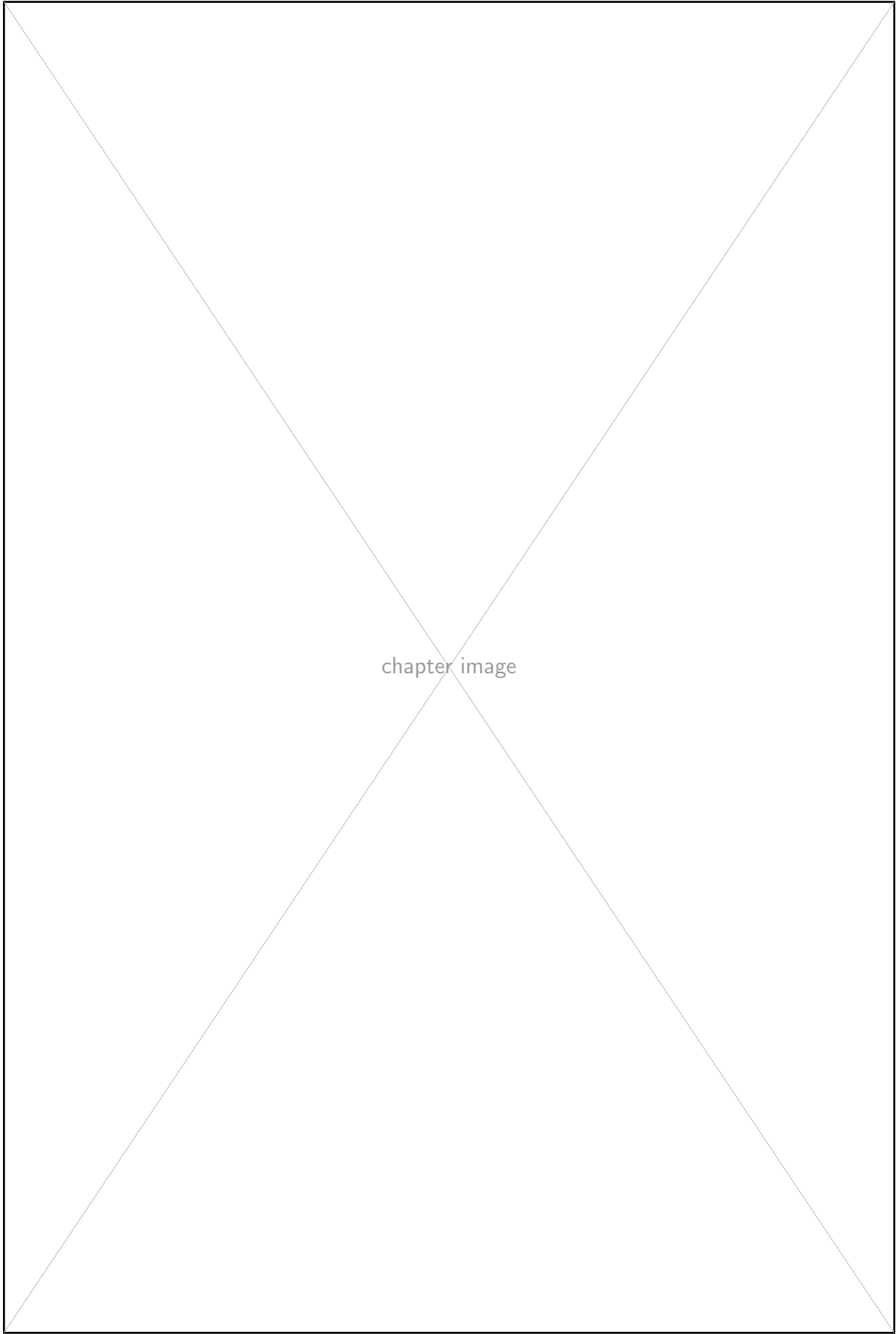
- 2 x 160g tins tuna in olive oil, drained
- 4 eggs
- 200g fine green beans, trimmed
- 200g cherry tomatoes, halved
- 100g pitted Niçoise olives
- 4 anchovy fillets
- 1/2 red onion, very finely sliced
- Mixed salad leaves
- 3 tbsp extra virgin olive oil
- 1 tbsp red wine vinegar
- 1 tsp Dijon mustard
- Salt & black pepper

Instructions

1. Boil the eggs for 7 minutes, then plunge into cold water. Peel and halve.
2. Blanch the green beans in salted boiling water for 3 minutes. Drain and refresh in cold water.
3. Make the dressing: whisk together the olive oil, vinegar, and mustard. Season well.
4. Arrange the salad leaves on a large platter. Dress lightly.
5. Arrange the tuna, eggs, beans, tomatoes, and olives on top. Scatter over the red onion and anchovies.
6. Drizzle the remaining dressing over everything and serve immediately.

Hints & Tips

- Don't toss — a Niçoise is a composed salad. Everything should be arranged, not mixed.
- Use tuna in olive oil, not brine. The quality of the tuna matters here.
- The dressing also works as a general-purpose vinaigrette.





SIDES



FEIJÃO

Beans are a staple in Brazil, and an artform. The nuances are endless; the quality of the bean, the age of the bean, soaking time, cooking time, how much liquid to leave in the pan, how to handle the garlic. It's a shame that Baked Beans have such a stranglehold on the UK. Europe has a much finer appreciation, with dishes like cassoulet, fabada, cocido and feijoada. Mastering beans is a worthwhile endeavour, and for that, you need to make friends with a pressure cooker.

Ingredients

- Black turtle beans
- Garlic
- Lardons
- Bay leaves
- Olive oil
- Salt
- Pepper

Instructions

1. Pressure cook the beans and Bay Leaves for 1 hour, or ~40 minutes if pre-soaked.
2. Sauté the garlic and lardons in olive oil until fragrant.
3. Add the sautéed mixture to the cooked beans and pressure cook for a further 15 minutes.
4. Season with salt and pepper to taste.

Hints & Tips

- Any pork sausage or smoked meat can be used instead of lardons.
- Don't overcook the beans; they should be tender but not mushy.
- Don't add too much water; otherwise the beans will be soupy.
- Adding some dried chilli in with the garlic mix is unconventional, but has become standard in our house.
- Add chili sauce and farofa (manioc root powder) on top, for a true Brazilian experience.

JOLLOF RICE

Ingredients

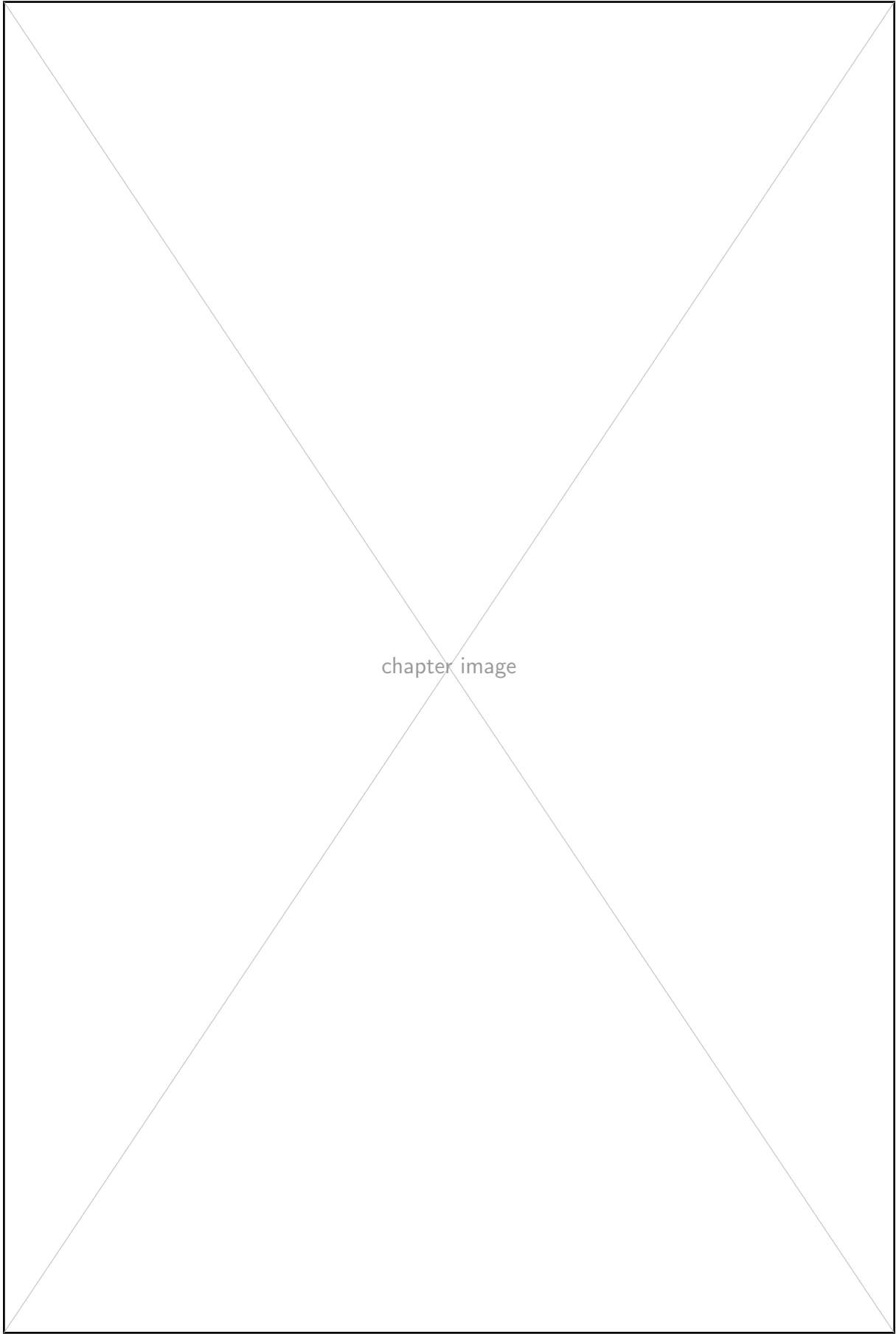
- 2 cups Rice - jasmine or basmati
- 1 Red pepper
- 2 Tomatoes
- Tomato paste
- 2 onions
- 1 Scotch bonnet pepper
- 4-6 cloves of garlic
- Chicken stock
- Neutral oil (vegetable/sunflower)
- Herbs: thyme, bay leaf
- Spices: fennel, clove, ginger, paprika, tumeric
- Salt & peper

Instructions

1. Sauce base: blend the red pepper, 1 onion, tomato with some chicken stock. Fry off and put aside.
2. Spice blend: In the same pan, fry the remaining onion, garlic, tomato paste, scotch bonnet and spices until fragrant.
3. Add the rice to the spice mix & coat the grains. Add half of the sauce base, stock and water. Add the bay leaves.
4. Bring to the boil, then simmer on low heat, covered, until rice is cooked (15-20 mins).
5. Stir through the remaining sauce base, thyme, adjust seasoning and serve.

Hints & Tips

- Not too much spice or tumeric - Jollof is meant to be red, not orange!
- Excess sauce base can be served on the side.
- Add oil or butter towards the end of cooking, to prevent the rice becoming dry





MAINS



COD WITH MORCILLA

I like this dish as the lightness of the cod complements the richness of the morcilla, while the chickpeas bulk it out. Cod can be expensive, so haddock can substitute, although it has a tendency to disintegrate in the pan. There's a wide range of sausage from Spain and Portugal. I tend to buy Portuguese morcilla, as it's readily available in Brazilian/Portuguese supermarkets. There is also chouriço, which looks similar, but has more paprika or even red wine in some varieties.

Ingredients

- 4 thick cod fillets (skin on)
- 150g morcilla (or black pudding), sliced 1cm thick
- 1 red pepper
- 1 tin of chickpeas
- 1 red onion, finely sliced
- 3 cloves garlic, crushed
- 200ml fish stock, chicken stock or white wine
- 1 tsp saffron
- 1 tbsp paprika - smoked or sweet, according to taste
- Handful flat-leaf parsley, roughly chopped
- Olive oil
- Salt & black pepper

Instructions

1. Fry the morcilla slices in a little olive oil over medium-high heat until crisp. Remove and set aside.
2. In the same pan, soften the onion and garlic for 5 minutes. Add the paprika and saffron and stir for 30 seconds.
3. Add the chickpeas and liquid.
4. Nestle the cod fillets skin-side up. Cover and cook on low-medium heat for 10–12 minutes until just cooked through.
5. Return the morcilla to the pan, crisp up under the grill, scatter with parsley, and serve directly from the pan.

Hints & Tips

- Don't overcook the cod — it should just flake apart. Check at 10 minutes.
- Chouriço / chorizo works as a substitute if morcilla is hard to find, though the flavour is quite different.

LAMB SHANK CURRY

Slow-braised lamb shanks in a deeply spiced South Asian-style gravy. The meat falls off the bone and the sauce is rich enough to eat with a spoon.

Ingredients

- 2 lamb shanks
- 2 onions, finely diced
- 4 cloves garlic, minced
- 2cm piece ginger, grated
- 400g tin chopped tomatoes
- 200ml lamb or chicken stock
- 2 tbsp neutral oil
- 1 tsp cumin seeds
- 1 tsp coriander, ground
- 1 tsp turmeric
- 1 tsp garam masala
- 1 tsp kashmiri chilli powder
- Salt to taste
- Fresh coriander and sliced green chilli to finish

Instructions

1. Season the lamb shanks generously with salt. Brown all over in oil in a heavy-bottomed pot over high heat. Remove and set aside.
2. In the same pot, fry the cumin seeds for 30 seconds, then add the onions. Cook on medium heat for 15–20 minutes until deeply golden.
3. Add the garlic and ginger, cook for 2 minutes. Add all the ground spices and stir for 1 minute.
4. Add the tomatoes and cook down for 5 minutes until the oil separates from the masala.
5. Return the lamb shanks to the pot. Add the stock — it should come about halfway up the shanks. Bring to a simmer.
6. Cover and cook on the lowest heat for 2–2.5 hours, turning the shanks halfway, until the meat is completely tender and falling off the bone.
7. Uncover and reduce the gravy for 10 minutes if it needs thickening. Finish with garam masala, fresh coriander and green chilli.

Hints & Tips

- The long, slow cook is non-negotiable — lamb shanks need time to become truly tender.
- This is even better the next day once the flavours have developed.
- Serve with rice or naan and a cooling raita.

SHORT RIBS WITH SPICED GRAVY

Beef short ribs braised low and slow in a warming spiced gravy. A weekend project that rewards patience.

Ingredients

- 4 bone-in beef short ribs (about 300g each)
- 2 onions, roughly chopped
- 3 cloves garlic, whole
- 2 carrots, roughly chopped
- 400ml red wine
- 400ml beef stock
- 2 tbsp tomato paste
- 1 cinnamon stick
- 3 cloves
- 1 tsp allspice
- 2 bay leaves
- Salt & black pepper
- Neutral oil for browning

Instructions

1. Season the short ribs well with salt and pepper. Brown all over in batches in a hot, oiled roasting tin or heavy pot. Remove and set aside.
2. Fry the onion, carrot, and garlic in the same pan for 5 minutes. Add the tomato paste and stir for 1 minute.
3. Add the wine and let it reduce by half. Add the stock, cinnamon, cloves, allspice, and bay leaves.
4. Return the short ribs to the pan. The liquid should come about two-thirds up the ribs.
5. Cover tightly with foil or a lid and cook at 160°C for 3–3.5 hours until the meat is tender and pulling away from the bone.
6. Remove the ribs and strain the cooking liquid into a saucepan. Reduce over high heat until glossy and sauce-like.
7. Return the ribs to the sauce to glaze before serving.

Hints & Tips

- This benefits massively from being made a day ahead — skim the fat off the chilled sauce before reheating.
- Serve with creamy mashed potato or soft polenta to catch the sauce.
- Ask the butcher for English-cut ribs (short, thick sections) rather than flanken-cut.

PUTTANESCA

Punchy, briny, and deeply savoury — this storecupboard pasta comes together in the time it takes to boil water. No fresh ingredients required.

Ingredients

- 400g spaghetti or linguine
- 2 x 400g tins chopped tomatoes
- 6 anchovy fillets in oil
- 3 cloves garlic, thinly sliced
- 80g pitted black olives, roughly chopped
- 2 tbsp capers, drained
- 1/2 tsp dried chilli flakes
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- Salt & black pepper
- Fresh parsley (optional)

Instructions

1. Cook the pasta in well-salted boiling water according to packet instructions. Reserve a cup of pasta water before draining.
2. While the pasta cooks, heat olive oil in a large pan over medium heat. Add the anchovies and stir until they dissolve into the oil.
3. Add the garlic and chilli flakes, cook for 1 minute. Add the tomatoes and a pinch of salt.
4. Simmer the sauce for 10 minutes. Stir in the olives and capers and cook for 2 more minutes.
5. Drain the pasta and toss directly in the sauce, adding a splash of pasta water to loosen if needed.
6. Season, finish with parsley if using, and serve immediately.

Hints & Tips

- Don't add extra salt until you've tasted — anchovies, olives and capers are all very salty.
- The sauce can be made ahead and refrigerated for up to 3 days.
- No anchovies? Double the capers and add a teaspoon of miso for depth.

SHAKSHUKA WITH FETA

This is a great dish, and works for breakfast, lunch or dinner. I like to use the pepper paste and make sure that the bitterness of the peppers balances the sweetness of the tomatoes.

Ingredients

- 6-8 eggs
- 100g feta, cubed
- 2 x 400g tins chopped tomatoes
- 2 red peppers, deseeded and diced
- 1 onion, finely diced
- 4 cloves garlic, sliced
- 1 tbsp of adjvar (Turkish pepper paste)
- 1 tbsp of good-quality harissa
- Olive oil
- Salt & black pepper
- Fresh coriander parsley to finish

Instructions

1. Heat olive oil in a wide, lidded frying pan over medium heat. Fry the onion, garlic and peppers for 8–10 minutes until soft.
2. Add the harissa and pepper paste. Stir for 1 minute.
3. Add the tomatoes. Season well. Simmer uncovered for 15 minutes, stirring occasionally, until the sauce thickens.
4. Add the cubed feta, pushing it below the surface of the sauce.
5. Make wells in the sauce and crack an egg into each one.
6. Cover with a lid and cook on low heat for 6–8 minutes, until the whites are set but yolks are still runny.
7. Scatter with parsley and serve immediately, straight from the pan with flatbreads.

Hints & Tips

- I use the back of a ladle, cracking the egg into the ladle, and rotating to let the egg slide into the depression
- Leave the feta in good-sized cubes, so it can stand-up to cooking.
- The sauce is fine the next day, but the eggs can be a little rubbery

BRAISED BRISKET

A satisfying winter dish, best cooked low and slow. This is a Jewish-style brisket, rather than Texas smoked brisket. I've found that not all brisket is equal, and ideally you should source a centre-cut flat brisket, with minimal hard fat. Supermarket brisket is often a risky purchase, because the shrink-wrapping forces the brisket into a lump, which unravels when you open it. As always, a decent butcher is the safest bet for a good cut, although likely pricier.

Ingredients

- 1.5kg centre-cut flat brisket
- Root vegetables - parsnip, potato
- Soffrito or celery
- Bay leaves
- 500ml decent beef stock

Instructions

1. In a large oven dish, pour the stock and mix in the soffrito and bay leaves
2. Place all other ingredients into the pan - meat in the middle, vegetables round the outside
3. Wrap in foil, and roast for ~3-4 hours, until the meat is tender.
4. Once the meat is cooked, take the dish out of the oven. Put the vegetables aside to serve, pour the gravy into a saucepan to thicken
5. Roast the meat on it's own for 10 minutes in a hot oven, to crisp it up

Hints & Tips

- You can strain the liquor, and add corn flour to thicken, for a more glossy gravy
- You could add mixed spice to the gravy, if you wanted a more distinctive flavour.
- Miso is always an easy-win, if the gravy lacks punch.

FABADA ASTURIANA

We don't do beans very well in the UK. Baked beans seem to have a stranglehold. There are a lot of good Spanish and Portuguese bean dishes, not to mention French cassoulet. This dish is closest to a Fabada Asturiana from Northern Spain. I like to use large white beans for this one. Tinned canellini beans are ok, but starting with good quality dried beans is best. This recipe is fairly similar to the cod with morcilla recipe, although it's a bit less labour intensive, and relies more on paprika

Ingredients

- 500g dried white beans
- 1 chorizo ring
- 800g Pork shoulder
- 1 onion
- 1 small bulb of garlic or ~5-6 large cloves
- Bay leaves
- Smoked pancetta
- 1 tsp smoked paprika
- Soffrito, or vegetable stock.
- Flat-leaf parsley
- Salt & pepper

Instructions

1. Cook the beans plus bay leaves, until the beans are 3/4 cooked. The cooking time will depend on the method and bean, but I would aim for 30 minutes using pre-soaked beans and a pressure cooker
2. In a separate pan, fry-off the pancetta, onion and garlic and add to the beans
3. Next fry off small pieces of chorizo, and add to the beans.
4. Finally brown the pork shoulder; and deglaze the pan with the stock, or bean liquor
5. With all of the ingredients in the pan, minus the parsley, cook for another 15 minutes. Longer if you like the pork more tender
6. Once cooked, add the chopped parsley & serve

Hints & Tips

- This dish can be fairly economical

KOFTE WITH TAHINI SAUCE

This is a flexible dish, with a varied history. Living in North London, Kofte is usually Turkish and lamb-based, but I've also enjoyed making Ottolenghi's [Kofter b'siniyah](<https://noseychef.com/2019/12/11/kofta-bsiniyah-ottolenghi/>) which are more heavily spiced, and even a version with lemongrass. I generally want two types of meat in this dish and something to stop it being too dense. I find turkey keeps it light, and the veal is just fatty enough.

Ingredients

- ~400g Turkey mince.
- ~400g Veal mince.
- 1 clove of garlic, finely chopped
- 1 small shallot, very finely chopped
- 100g breadcrumbs
- 1 tsp chilli flakes
- Half a preserved lemon
- herbs - flat-leaf parsley, coriander
- salt & pepper
- Sauce: 100g tahini, splash of olive oil, 50ml water, lemon juice, crushed garlic clove.

Instructions

1. Put all the kofte ingredients in a bowl. Mix with your hands until homogenised
2. Make the kofte, keeping a consistent size
3. Bake at 180 for 20 minutes, or grill on a medium heat
4. Mix the sauce, and leave for the garlic to infuse. The consistency should like single cream.

Hints & Tips

- Smaller kofte cook quicker, but take longer to make.
- I find the best shape to be a mini rugby-ball. About 3 tbsp of meat per kofte
- You can also use pork and/or lamb. Once mince can be lean, but one should be fatty

PORK WITH LENTILS

A hearty French bistro classic — braised pork with Puy lentils. The lentils absorb the cooking juices and become deeply savoury, and the whole thing improves overnight.

Ingredients

- 600g pork shoulder or loin, cut into chunks
- 250g Puy lentils
- 1 onion, finely diced
- 2 carrots, diced
- 2 celery stalks, diced
- 3 garlic cloves, crushed
- 200ml white wine
- 500ml chicken or pork stock
- 1 bay leaf
- Few sprigs of thyme
- Dijon mustard, to serve

Instructions

1. Season the pork generously. Brown in batches in a heavy casserole over high heat, then set aside.
2. In the same pan, soften the onion, carrot, and celery over medium heat for 5–8 minutes.
3. Add the garlic and cook for a further minute.
4. Deglaze with the white wine and reduce by half.
5. Return the pork to the pan. Add the lentils, stock, bay leaf, and thyme.
6. Bring to a simmer; cover, and cook on a low heat for 45–55 minutes, until the lentils are tender and the pork is cooked through.
7. Adjust seasoning and serve with a spoonful of Dijon on the side.

Hints & Tips

- Puy lentils hold their shape best here — avoid red lentils, which will turn to mush.
- A splash of red wine vinegar stirred in at the end brightens the whole dish.